

Valentin Achterberg

Character Dossier

Gentle and slow to trust clockmaker of the Frostwall garrison on the northern border

Overview

Valentin Achterberg is a clockmaker living in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border. Valentin is 39 years old, originally from Solace, and is known around the east rampart as gentle and slow to trust. In conversation Valentin counts things aloud when nervous.

Background

Valentin arrived in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border 12 years ago after leaving Solace under circumstances Valentin describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Frostwall Legion; the second was the one that stuck. Today Valentin works as a clockmaker near the quartermaster's stores and is paid, when paid at all, in iron pennies.

Valentin learned the trade from Octavia Ravensworth, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Valentin's life is with Ignatius Marchetti, over a matter neither will explain. The person Valentin trusts most is Osric Ashgrove.

Current goal: to see the ocean once. Greatest fear: fire in enclosed spaces.

Personality and speech

Temperament: gentle and slow to trust.

Speech pattern: Valentin counts things aloud when nervous.

Tells: when lying, Valentin mentions Sable the hawk for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Valentin Achterberg
<i>Role</i>	clockmaker
<i>Home</i>	the Frostwall garrison on the northern border
<i>Hometown</i>	Solace
<i>Age</i>	39
<i>Favourite dish</i>	twice-cooked coconut porridge
<i>Pet</i>	Sable, a hawk
<i>Lucky number</i>	338

<i>Workshop password</i>	copper-cinder
<i>Mentor</i>	Octavia Ravensworth
<i>Rival</i>	Ignatius Marchetti
<i>Closest friend</i>	Osric Ashgrove

Secret

Valentin cannot actually read the old script everyone assumes they can, and has memorised the important pages.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Valentin: I am the clockmaker. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Valentin: Twice-cooked coconut porridge. Do not tell Ignatius I said so.

Visitor: Is Sable yours?

Valentin: Sable belongs to nobody. Sable tolerates me. Lucky number is 338, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 39

Valentin was hired to carry a spool of wire from the frozen moat to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Valentin spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 79 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. The weather turned. Valentin moved the cracked compass indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the new curfew. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osric and is probably right. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 2, summer of year 39

Octavia visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. Nkechi came by asking about the singing at the docks. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead. Valentin won 80 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osric and is probably right.

Entry 3, winter of year 39

The weather turned. Valentin moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the quarantine. Valentin repaired the clockwork bird at the signal tower for Jorah, who paid in 18 iron pennies and a long story about the old tunnels. Ursula came by asking about the singing at the docks. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 4, autumn of year 39

Rumours about the old tunnels reached the east rampart. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Valentin moved the glass float indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the census. Valentin closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. Sable followed at a distance. Valentin repaired the grain scale at the east rampart for Winifred, who paid in 89 iron pennies and a long story about the census. Valentin was hired to carry a copper pipe from the east rampart to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 5, spring of year 40

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the quarantine. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Valentin closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Sable followed at a distance. Winifred came by asking about the census. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 6, winter of year 40

Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osric and is probably right. Eamon came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea

instead. Valentin won 89 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Valentin and Ignatius outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Kenji came by asking about the comet. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 7, summer of year 40

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the old tunnels. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Kestrel came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the quartermaster's stores. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the quartermaster's stores. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the quartermaster's stores. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 8, autumn of year 40

Valentin was hired to carry a oilskin map from the quartermaster's stores to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the quartermaster's stores, Valentin taught Osric how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone. Valentin spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 29 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short. Valentin repaired the wax seal at the quartermaster's stores for Lucienne, who paid in 18 iron pennies and a long story about the new curfew. Valentin won 77 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge.

Entry 9, autumn of year 40

Valentin repaired the iron kettle at the mess hall for Orsolya, who paid in 19 iron pennies and a long story about the comet. Valentin won 56 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. Rumours about the comet reached the mess hall. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 10, spring of year 40

Valentin was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the east rampart to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Valentin repaired the ledger at the east rampart for Torvald, who paid in 25 iron pennies and a long story about the rumour of a second well. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osric and is probably right. Rumours about the census reached the east rampart. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 11, autumn of year 40

A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Valentin and Ignatius outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osric and is probably right. Valentin closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Sable followed at a distance. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osric and is probably right.

Entry 12, spring of year 40

The weather turned. Valentin moved the wax seal indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the census. A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Valentin and Ignatius outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Valentin found a tin whistle half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Valentin found a wax seal half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Valentin moved the glass float indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the harvest count.

Entry 13, winter of year 41

Octavia visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the comet flared up between Valentin and Ignatius outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the tax on doors. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 14, spring of year 41

Valentin won 35 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. Dorothea came by asking about the quarantine. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osrice and is probably right. Someone left a bolt of linen on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osrice and is probably right.

Entry 15, winter of year 41

Bram came by asking about who really won the regatta. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. At the signal tower, Valentin taught Osrice how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 16, winter of year 41

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Valentin and Ignatius outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Valentin moved the coil of rope indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the singing at the docks. At the east rampart, Valentin taught Osrice how to tell a real hand bell from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 17, summer of year 42

Valentin spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 62 of everything, except the bundle of letters, which is always short. Valentin spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 76 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. Valentin closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Sable followed at a distance.

Entry 18, summer of year 42

At the east rampart, Valentin taught Osric how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Valentin repaired the cracked compass at the east rampart for Rurik, who paid in 88 iron pennies and a long story about the census.

Entry 19, autumn of year 42

Valentin won 31 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. Valentin won 63 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. Valentin spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 66 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short. Valentin was hired to carry a grain scale from the east rampart to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 20, winter of year 42

Rumours about the harvest count reached the frozen moat. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Valentin was hired to carry a grain scale from the frozen moat to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Valentin found a hand bell half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 21, autumn of year 43

At the signal tower, Valentin taught Osric how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Valentin repaired the bolt of linen at the signal tower for Zora, who paid in 62 iron pennies and a long story about the census. Valentin found a cracked compass half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 22, spring of year 43

The weather turned. Valentin moved the hand bell indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the tax on doors. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Valentin found a bundle of letters half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the mess hall, Valentin taught Osric how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone. Valentin won 2 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge.

Entry 23, autumn of year 43

Valentin closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. Sable followed at a distance. The weather turned. Valentin moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the tariff on salt. Valentin won 38 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge.

Entry 24, summer of year 43

Valentin found a coil of rope half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the mess hall, Valentin taught Osric how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. Ulla came by asking about the quarantine. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea

instead.

Entry 25, autumn of year 43

Valentin spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 24 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short. Valentin repaired the hand bell at the frozen moat for Ulla, who paid in 64 iron pennies and a long story about the right way to mend a net. At the frozen moat, Valentin taught Osric how to tell a real cracked compass from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 26, winter of year 43

Rumours about the tax on doors reached the signal tower. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Valentin was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the signal tower to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the new curfew reached the signal tower. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Valentin moved the ledger indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the tax on doors. Valentin repaired the sextant at the signal tower for Dashiell, who paid in 10 iron pennies and a long story about the harvest count.

Entry 27, spring of year 43

Valentin won 62 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. Valentin won 69 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. Valentin spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 9 of everything, except the spool of wire, which is always short. Valentin spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 7 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short. Someone left a hand bell on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osric and is probably right.

Entry 28, winter of year 43

The weather turned. Valentin moved the cracked compass indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the rumour of a second well. Valentin found a clockwork bird half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Valentin was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the mess hall to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Valentin spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 81 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the mess hall. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 29, summer of year 43

Octavia visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the frozen moat, Valentin taught Osric how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. Valentin was hired to carry a hand bell from the frozen moat to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 30, autumn of year 43

The weather turned. Valentin moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the comet. Baptiste came by asking about the tax on doors. Valentin said nothing useful

and made tea instead. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Valentin and Ignatius outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the mess hall, Valentin taught Osric how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 31, summer of year 43

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Valentin repaired the coil of rope at the quartermaster's stores for Soren, who paid in 60 iron pennies and a long story about the quarantine. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Valentin spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 62 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. A dispute over the comet flared up between Valentin and Ignatius outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 32, summer of year 43

Orsolya came by asking about the tariff on salt. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead. Valentin won 87 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about the census and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. The weather turned. Valentin moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the right way to mend a net. Valentin was hired to carry a copper pipe from the frozen moat to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 33, winter of year 43

Valentin won 36 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about the census and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. Octavia visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. Quillon came by asking about the tariff on salt. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead. Octavia visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 34, summer of year 43

Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osric and is probably right. Valentin closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Sable followed at a distance. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 35, autumn of year 43

Valentin repaired the tin whistle at the mess hall for Imogen, who paid in 25 iron pennies and a long story about the old tunnels. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osric and is probably right.

Entry 36, spring of year 43

Valentin closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. Sable followed at a distance. Petra came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead. Valentin closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. Sable followed at a distance.

Entry 37, spring of year 43

Octavia visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Valentin won 13 iron pennies from Ignatius on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on twice-cooked coconut porridge. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the east rampart. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Torvald came by asking about who really won the regatta. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead. Valentin was hired to carry a oilskin map from the east rampart to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 38, autumn of year 43

Valentin was hired to carry a brass lantern from the mess hall to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Valentin and Ignatius outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Valentin moved the bolt of linen indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the old tunnels. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Valentin closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. Sable followed at a distance.

Entry 39, spring of year 43

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the quarantine. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Valentin repaired the ledger at the quartermaster's stores for Seraphine, who paid in 3 iron pennies and a long story about the price of lamp oil. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Valentin spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 62 of everything, except the tin whistle, which is always short.

Entry 40, spring of year 43

Juniper came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Valentin found a grain scale half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 41, spring of year 43

Valentin spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 3 of everything, except the spool of wire, which is always short. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Valentin and Ignatius outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Valentin for the password to the workshop. Valentin laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 42, autumn of year 43

Valentin repaired the bolt of linen at the signal tower for Dorothea, who paid in 63 iron pennies and a long story about who really won the regatta. The weather turned. Valentin moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Sable, and wrote three lines to Octavia about the new curfew. Lysander came by asking about the harvest count. Valentin said nothing useful and made tea instead. Valentin repaired the glass

float at the signal tower for Dorothea, who paid in 44 iron pennies and a long story about the tariff on salt.

Entry 43, autumn of year 43

Someone left a coil of rope on the doorstep with no note. Valentin suspects Osric and is probably right. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the mess hall. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Valentin repaired the signal flag at the mess hall for Brigid, who paid in 65 iron pennies and a long story about the census.

Entry 44, spring of year 43

Valentin found a oilskin map half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Octavia visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Valentin repaired the iron kettle at the mess hall for Zubair, who paid in 43 iron pennies and a long story about the quarantine. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the census. Valentin read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 45, summer of year 44

Valentin found a oilskin map half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about the tax on doors reached the east rampart. Valentin pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Octavia visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Valentin spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 82 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Valentin was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the east rampart to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded.